

Flower Dedication

The beautiful flowers adorning the sanctuary this morning are given in honor of our children, Martha, John, and Betsy.
— *Andy and Lauren Butler*

Announcements

Roca Blanca Project Fund. Our mission team needs help funding the work they will do while in Mexico. Giving to the RB Project Fund will go directly to purchasing food baskets for hungry people and buying supplies for all projects the team will complete while on the base. Envelopes are available at the Narthex and East Entrance. Thank you for participating in the work of the Lord at home and in other countries!

Samaritan’s Purse Shoeboxes. Collection boxes are available in the children’s wing and the side entrance by the church office. You can participate by shopping and collecting items, or by donating monetarily — each shoebox costs \$10 to ship. Items needed: small composition notebooks, pencils, small cars/trucks, puzzles, jump ropes, hair bows/barrettes/brushes/combs, underwear in larger sizes, and small stuffed animals. No liquids, candy, or food!

Those Who Serve Today

Assisting Elder — Zeb Taylor

Greeters — Randy & Penny Long

Acolytes — Cecil Sexton & Sally Grace McCullough

Circle of Prayer — Johnny & Jill Taylor

Ushers — Dave Shanklin, Peter Fisher, Cameron Crockett, JR Burns, & Nick Ashmore

Nursery — Laura Kate Carmichiel, Robert & Sallie Kate Williams, Ashley Majors, Tara Mathis, & Jeannie Blackwelder

AV Engineer — Russell Smith

Church Staff

Rev. Waring Porter - Pastor

Gregg Parker - Dir. of Discipleship

Bobby Capps - Dir. of Outreach & Care

Jennifer Shipp - Dir. of Student Ministries

Laura Kate Carmichiel - Dir. of Women’s Min. & Comm.

Phyllis Sellers - Day School Director

Jan Pike - Choir Director

Malechi Doren - Accompanist

Teresa Tsagarakis - Administrative Assistant

Sammy Allred - Bookkeeper

The Church Calendar

September 7 Labor Day — Church Office Closed

September 8 Women’s Bible Study — Youth House, 8 a.m.

September 9 KidsQuest · Youth · Women’s Bible Study, 6 p.m.

September 10 MI3 Week 5

September 13 Session Meeting · Deacons’ Meeting · Women’s Ministry Overview Meeting, 4 p.m., Youth House

September 17 Joy Riders Lunch — Pickwick State Park

September 19 Outdoor Movie Night: *Mary Poppins Returns*, 6:30 p.m.

Online Giving



Scan to give online



FIRST PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH

September 6, 2026

Fifteenth Sunday after Pentecost

“To be disciples, to make disciples”

Welcome

We Are Glad You Are Here!

We are honored that you decided to join us this morning. Whether it is your first time in church, your first time in a long while, or part of your regular rhythm, we hope you will be encouraged by the fellowship with each other, and with our Lord, as we worship him together.

If this is your first time with us, please take a moment and fill out a Next Steps Card found on the back of the pew. We would love to meet you and help you get connected.

Children & Nursery

Children (age 4+) and their families worship together in the sanctuary, where children will be dismissed to Children’s Church during the service. Children’s bulletins and crayons are available at both entrances to the Sanctuary. Children are always welcome in worship!

Nursery rooms for infants through age 3 are in the Education Wing, with the entrance behind the playground on the west side of campus. If you have a newborn and/or are nursing your baby, please feel free to use our baby room just off the narthex — a quiet space with comfortable seating where the worship service is broadcast as well.

Our Vision & Mission

Our vision is to see lives transformed by the power of the gospel, rooted in God’s Word and the Reformed tradition, in order to create a culture of discipleship at FPC where disciples WORSHIP holistically, GROW relationally in Christ, and SERVE boldly in the world for the glory of God. Our mission is to accomplish this by “Being Disciples and Making Disciples.”

Connect With Us

Website: fpccorinth.org
Phone: 662-286-6638
Address: 919 East Shiloh Rd, Corinth, MS 38834

Sermon Outline

“Restored by Grace: Depending on God Alone”

Rev. Waring Porter · Ezra 8:1–23

Ezra and a group of God’s people are preparing for a long and potentially dangerous journey from Babylon to Jerusalem. They have families. They have possessions. They are carrying valuable resources for the temple. They know there are dangers along the way. Ezra has a choice: Where will they place their confidence? What will they depend upon to get them safely to Jerusalem?

We live in a culture where we are constantly challenged to ask the same questions, and are constantly choosing our own “survival gear.” We need to understand there is a difference between using something God provides and trusting it to provide the security only God can give. Ezra 8 asks us a penetrating question: When the journey becomes uncertain, what, or whom, do we really depend upon?

I. God Provides (vv. 1–20)

II. Dependence upon God (vv. 21–23)

III. God Sustains (vv. 21–23)

Resources: Matthew Henry’s Commentary, Vol. 2, Matthew Henry; Ezra & Nehemiah, Derek Kidner; Ezra & Nehemiah, Jacob M. Myers; Westminster Confession of Faith

*The Doxology and Prayer of Dedication

*Praise God, from whom all blessings flow; Praise Him, all creatures here below;
Praise Him above, ye heavenly host; Praise Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. Amen.*

WORD

Scripture Reading

Ezra 8:1–23 · Pew Bible, p. 394

Scripture Response: Isaiah 40:6b, 8

Leader: All flesh is grass, and all its beauty is like the flower of the field;
*All: The grass withers, the flower fades, but the Word of our God will stand forever.
Amen.*

Sermon: “Restored by Grace: Depending on God Alone”

Rev. Waring Porter

Prayer of Commitment

SENDING

O GOD, OUR HELP IN
AGES PAST

Written by Isaac Watts in 1719, this is a hymn of trust in God’s faithfulness amid the uncertainty and brevity of life. As our closing hymn, it gathers the liturgy’s themes of dependence and providence into a confident declaration that God, not earthly security, is our help and hope. The final verse is especially fitting: “O God, our help in ages past, our hope for years to come, be Thou our guard while life shall last, and our eternal home.” It sends us trusting God’s care for both the present and the future.

*Hymn: #52

“O God, Our Help in Ages Past” (marked verses)

*Benediction

*Choral Benediction

Threefold Amen

*Postlude

LITURGY FOR THE WORSHIP OF GOD

September 6, 2026

** Indicates congregation standing if able*

Our worship is a covenant conversation between God and His people. Throughout the service, God graciously speaks to us through His Word, and we joyfully respond with praise, confession, prayer, faith, thanksgiving, and obedience.

GATHERING

The Piano Prelude

PRELUDE

The prelude provides a quiet moment to prepare for worship. As the music begins, we are encouraged to calm our hearts, focus our minds, and enter reverently into God’s presence.

Greetings & Announcements

Call to Meditation: Psalm 46:10

“Be still, and know that I am God. I will be exalted among the nations, I will be exalted in the earth!”

The Prelude

Choral Introit

“Glorify Thy Name”

*Call to Worship: from Psalm 20

Leader: Beloved of God, we gather today not because we trust in our own strength, wisdom, or resources, but because our help is in the name of the Lord.

All: May the Lord answer you in the day of trouble! May the name of the God of Jacob protect you!

Leader: May He send you help from the sanctuary and give you support from Zion!

All: May He remember all your offerings and regard with favor your burnt sacrifices!

Leader: May He grant you your heart’s desire and fulfill all your plans!

All: Now I know that the Lord saves His anointed; He will answer him from His holy heaven with the saving might of His right hand.

Leader: Some trust in chariots and some in horses—

All: But we trust in the name of the Lord our God!

Leader: They collapse and fall, but we rise and stand upright.

All: O Lord, save the king! May He answer us when we call.

*The Hymn: #204

“Rock of Ages” (vv. 1–3)

ROCK OF AGES

This hymn, written by Augustus Toplady in 1776, is a hymn of humble dependence upon Christ and His saving grace. Its emphasis on finding refuge in Christ rather than in our own efforts or resources introduces the central theme of this liturgy: our true security is found in God alone. This prepares us to hear Jesus’ call in Matthew 6 to trust our heavenly Father rather than be anxious about tomorrow.

THE LORD’S PRAYER
Jesus gives the Lord’s Prayer in the context of teaching His disciples how to pray and trust their heavenly Father (Matthew 6:9–13). Praying this prayer together reinforces the call to turn from self-reliance and anxiety to dependence upon God — trusting Him for our daily bread, forgiveness, protection, and provision.

***Prayer of Invocation & The Lord’s Prayer**

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy Kingdom come, thy will be done on earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen.

***The New Testament Reading: Matthew 6:25–34**

Leader: “Therefore I tell you, do not be anxious about your life, what you will eat or what you will drink, nor about your body, what you will put on. Is not life more than food, and the body more than clothing? Look at the birds of the air: they neither sow nor reap nor gather into barns, and yet your heavenly Father feeds them. Are you not of more value than they? And which of you by being anxious can add a single hour to his span of life? And why are you anxious about clothing? Consider the lilies of the field, how they grow: they neither toil nor spin, yet I tell you, even Solomon in all his glory was not arrayed like one of these. But if God so clothes the grass of the field, which today is alive and tomorrow is thrown into the oven, will he not much more clothe you, O you of little faith? Therefore do not be anxious, saying, ‘What shall we eat?’ or ‘What shall we drink?’ or ‘What shall we wear?’ For the Gentiles seek after all these things, and your heavenly Father knows that you need them all. But seek first the kingdom of God and his righteousness, and all these things will be added to you. Therefore do not be anxious about tomorrow, for tomorrow will be anxious for itself. Sufficient for the day is its own trouble.” This is the Word of the Lord.

All: Thanks be to God.

Hymn of Response: #204

“Rock of Ages” (v. 4)

Corporate Prayer of Confession

Merciful and faithful God, we confess that we are often tempted to trust in earthly things rather than in You. We place our confidence in our possessions, our health, our plans, our abilities, and the security we can create for ourselves. We worry about what we cannot control and forget that You are our refuge and provider. Forgive us, Lord, for trusting in our own strength rather than Your sovereign care. Forgive us for seeking security in the things of this world instead of seeking first Your kingdom and righteousness. Teach us to trust You when the way ahead is uncertain. Give us faith to pray, courage to obey, and confidence to rest in Your good providence. Thank You that our hope rests not in our faithfulness, but in Christ and His finished work. Turn our hearts from the false securities of this world and teach us to trust in Your name.

Silent Confession

Assurance of Divine Pardon: Psalm 103:8, 12

“The LORD is merciful and gracious, slow to anger and abounding in steadfast love... as far as the east is from the west, so far does he remove our transgressions from us.”

***Gloria Patri**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost; As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be: world without end. Amen.

***Profession of Faith: The Apostles’ Creed**

I believe in God, the Father almighty, Maker of heaven and earth, and in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Ghost, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead and buried; he descended into hell; the third day he rose again from the dead; he ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty; from thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead. I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.*

**that is, the true Christian church of all times and all places*

***Children Dismissed to Children’s Church**

Monthly Missionary Focus

*Dr. Steve Blair
Missions Committee Chairman*

The Giving of Tithes and Offerings

Choral Anthem

*“Speak, O Lord”
Keith Getty & Stuart Townend*

ASSURANCE OF PARDON
After confessing our sins, we hear God’s promise of forgiveness, reminding us that the good news of Jesus Christ meets our confession with grace. We are reminded that true repentance is always answered by God’s faithful forgiveness, and Christ’s saving work is greater than our sin.

CHILDREN’S CHURCH
Children ages 4 up to 4th grade are invited to come forward and exit out the side door for Children’s Church. Following the worship service, they may be picked up in the Fellowship Hall.

FPC MISSIONS
FPC currently provides prayer and financial support to over 50 international and domestic missionaries, along with 2 international ministry organizations and 6 local ministries. We want to introduce the congregation to several of these missionaries every month, so you can get to know them and pray specifically for them.